testimony, comparison and presumption (***arthapatti***); the *Mimamsaka* followers of ***Kumarila*** accept perception, inference, testimony, comparison, presumption and non-cognition (*anupalabdhi*). The Buddhist anti-realist sceptic ***Nagarjuna*** asks how we establish the validity of the pramanas that are supposed to establish the nature of objects. If we say that they do not need to be established, why do we think that objects need *pramanas* for their determination? But if we say that a *pramana* is established by another *pramana*, an infinite regress (***anavastha***) results.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; K. Bhattacharya 1998; Franco 1994; Matilal 1986; Potter 1977; Suryanarayana Shastri 1942

Pramana-samplava (co-extensivity of the means of knowledge): realists, especially the ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas*** and ***Purva Mimamsakas***, oppose the view of the ***Sautrantika*** Buddhists that conceptual thought and language are human constructions only indirectly related to the inexpressible, momentary real particulars (***svalakshana***) that are given only in perceptual sensation. They hold that our concepts, simple and complex, correspond to, by way of copying, reality as it is actually structured. Both individual entities and their properties are objective realities and may be known by sensory perception (***nirvikalpaka-pratyaksha***), concept-laden perception (***savikalpaka-pratyaksha***) and inference (***anumana***). Fire may be known by both perception and inference, as when its presence is deduced from that of smoke.

See ***Pramana-vyavastha***

Pramana-vyavastha: while the realists hold that, for instance, fire as a whole concrete reality may either be perceived by more than one of the senses, or grasped by inference,